

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

DIVORCE RATES IN SOUTH AFRICA

These divorce rates in South Africa are analysed over a period of three years, specifically, 2021 to 2023. There are three factors that will be used to analyse these divorce rates, namely:

- Female Occupation
- Plaintiff Sex
- Grounds for Divorce

The following are the total number of divorces that were recorded by Statistics of South Africa according to years:

- **2021 – 4936 divorces**
- **2022 – 5060 divorces**
- **2023 – 4930 divorces**

The divorces will be looked at over nine categories of female occupations and seven categories under grounds of divorce. Unemployment was the category under female occupation over the three years that had the highest number of divorce cases with Professional, semi-professional and technical occupations as the second highest category and Service occupations as the third highest category.

The four categories over the span of the three years with the highest number of divorce cases under the category of grounds of divorce were Adultery, Abuse, Desertion and Financial difficulties.

Over the three years, the leading plaintiff sex was female which was followed by male plaintiffs then both plaintiffs.

Our Data analysis answers the question as to whether there is a significant statistical association between female occupation and grounds for divorce. After conducting a Chi square distribution test, it was found that there was a statistically significant association between female occupations and grounds for divorce.